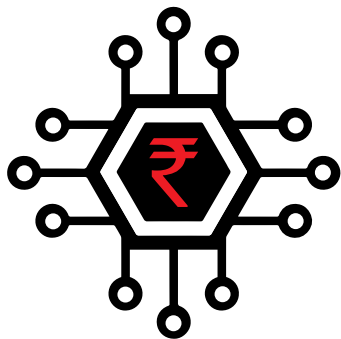




THE DIGITAL PILOT

KEEPING WITH THE deadline of 2023, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) commenced its pilot project on November 1, 2022 for launching the digital rupee, more popularly known as Central Bank Digital Currency, or CBDC. The first pilot is in the wholesale segment. The use case is the settlement of secondary market transactions in government

securities, which recorded a total value of ₹275 crore on the first day. The retail segment is planned for launch within a month in select locations in closed user groups. Currently, only nine banks have been identified for participation in the pilot. The CBDC's pilots will be closely watched for their efficacy and efficiency.

—TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL

THE 'INSIDE' INSIGHT

Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) Chairperson Madhabi Puri Buch has brought in a lot of changes at the capital market watchdog with a strong focus on technology and data. At a recent event, the first woman chief of Sebi highlighted the fact that an in-house algorithm developed by "young officers" of the regulator works like "magic" and throws alerts related to serious market offences like insider trading and front running. "You can look at the data and say here is this guy, look at his trading pattern, that's insider trading. It is as simple as that," she said.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

SOARING AMBITIONS

While laying the foundation stone of the C-295 transport aircraft manufacturing facility in Gujarat's Vadodara district, PM Narendra Modi said it had the potential to transform the country's aerospace and defence sectors. "I can see a time when some of the biggest passenger aircraft are also manufactured in India. And they will be carrying the words 'Made in India'," he declared. Once operational, the Tata Advanced Systems and Airbus Defence and Space's ₹22,000-crore JV will be the first private sector entity in



PHOTO BY ANI

both sectors. The first of the 40 Made in India aircraft is expected to roll out in H2 of 2026. The C-295 can take off or land on short or unprepared airstrips.

—MANISH PANT

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BILLION
INDIA'S FOREIGN
EXCHANGE
RESERVES
ON OCTOBER
21, 2022. THE
RESERVES ARE
AT THE LOWEST
LEVEL SINCE
JULY 2020



ONLINE RETAIL'S 'CRUCIBLE MOMENT'

India will have more online shoppers than the US in the next one-two years, trailing only China, per a report by Bain & Co. and Flipkart. There are roughly 180-190 million online shoppers today, a figure estimated to touch 400-450 million by 2027. Most new shoppers hail from Tier III+ towns, and belong to the GenZ demographic. Forty per cent of new sellers are also from Tier II+ regions.

—SOHINI MITTER

Google vs CCI

TWO SUCCESSIVE FINES totalling ₹2,274 crore have been imposed on Google by the Competition Commission of India. The first, of ₹1,338 crore, was for anti-competitive practices related to its mobile Android operating system. The second fine, of ₹936 crore, was for abusing its dominant market position to promote its payments app and in-app payment system. The technology giant has not made its next move public, although there is a good chance it will fight it out. By the looks of it, there could be a long legal battle.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN